

POWERPLAY — Mechanics Reference Card

The corporate compliance handbook your characters never bothered to read. Quick lookup of every named mechanic.

Power is checked, not spent unless explicitly paid (e.g., PowerPlay!, Character Ability) — the Board appreciates ambition without asking it to liquidate. All values per documents/POWERPLAY OFFICIAL INSTRUCTIONS 03072026.md § II.

Tier Floors (Universal) — pay-to-play, gilded edition

One unified Power-Floor scheme across Action, Reaction, and Asset interactions (RC-Z15-04 + RC-Z20-01). Lobbyists meet a lower bar than CEOs; CEOs meet a lower bar than oligarchs.

Tier	Action Power Floor	Reaction Power Floor	Asset Buy Floor	Asset Use Floor
T1	0 P	0 P	0 P	0 P
T2	1 P	1 P	1 P	1 P
T3	2 P	2 P	2 P	2 P

Applies to play / draw / peek of Action + Reaction cards of that tier, and to **draw / bid / Brokerage** of Assets of that tier. Same floor governs Asset ability **Use** (see Ability Lock).

Ability Lock — the perks-and-Power club

When a player's Power drops below an Asset's Use Floor, that Asset's ability is **locked** — cannot activate even if the trigger fires. The executive suite needs a sufficiently impressive resume. **Income still flows. Op Costs still apply** — the rank-and-file keeps the lights on regardless. Ability unlocks automatically when Power meets / exceeds the Use Floor again.

Counter Tier-Up (RC-Z14-03 + RC-Z15-02 + RC-Z15-03)

A Reaction may Counter an Action of **equal or lower** tier:

Action	Counterable by Reaction tier...
T1	T1, T2, or T3
T2	T2 or T3
T3	T3 only

Extends to all Reaction defensive effects (Cancel / Prevent / Redirect) per **Reaction Tier-Up Universal. Reaction-vs-Reaction is tier-flat** — any tier may target any tier. Reaction chains capped at **2** per Z10 chain rule.

Industry Synergy

A <Industry> Synergy: <effect> line on T2/T3 cards. Triggers if **the player who played the card** owns ≥1 Asset of that Industry. The Industry of any target/attached Asset is irrelevant — only the player's own portfolio counts. T1 cards are synergy-free (PR-Z14-C).

- **Action:** checked against the **Attacker's** Assets.
- **Reaction:** checked against the **Reactor's** Assets (may not be the Defender). (Z15)

Sacred (RC-Z13-05, clarified Z19 as RC-Z19-01) — above the audit

Some plays are simply too well-connected to question. A **Sacred** action, ability, or effect **cannot be Cancelled, Countered, Prevented, or Redirected** by any means (Reactions, asset abilities, character abilities, or any other source). PowerPlay! is Sacred. Specific character abilities may grant Sacred status to a designated play (see character cards).

PowerPlay! — Sacred Free Action

Pay **1 P** → **+1 Standard Action** this turn AND draw **1 Action card + 1 Reaction card**. Once per turn. Sacred.

Attach (RC-Z14-08)

A card persists on a target Asset (or player) until a condition is met or duration expires. **Default duration: until target/owner's next Conclude phase**. At each Conclude, remove expired Attached cards from your Assets and yourself. Cards may specify shorter durations (e.g., "next income roll, then discard"). **Multiple Action attachments may stack on the same Asset**. Financial tokens (Loans, IOUs) follow their own constraints and are NOT cleared at Conclude.

Loan (Corporate Debt) (RC-Z14-07) — patience with interest

Relationship: player ↔ supply (bank). No Attacker, no Defender — the bank is your counterparty. Distinct from an IOU (see below), which is player ↔ player.

- **Take a Loan** (Standard Action): up to **floor(printed cost / 2)** from supply, secured against an Asset (collateral → Asset Mortgaged).
 - **Max 2 active loans / player** (checked at own Conclude; if 3+, default one).
 - **Maintenance**: 1 C / active loan at CIAN. **Grace round** on round of acquisition.
 - **Voluntary repayment** (free at Conclude or CIAN): pay **principal + 1 C** → Asset unmortgaged.
 - **Default**: attached Asset → discard; bank pays printed cost to **the player**; the player pays principal + 1 C; the player keeps surplus (1 C / 3 C / 6 C for T1/T2/T3). Loan discharged. **No elimination from loan default**.
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IOU (Deferred Debt) (RC-Z14-06) — a polite gun at your head

Relationship: player ↔ player — the Defender owes the Attacker. Distinct from a Loan (above), which is player ↔ supply. The IOU lives in the Attacker's possession until settled or traded.

When an Action effect demands a resource the Defender lacks → Defender takes a **Coin-denominated IOU** held by the Attacker instead. The Board accepts promissory notes. The Board also remembers them.

Shortfall	IOU value (per missing unit)
1 IP	4 C (3 + 1 interest)
1 P	7 C (6 + 1 interest)
1 C	(X + 1) C

- **Cap**: 2 new IOUs / Defender / round (further triggers floor at 0).
 - **Settlement**: at CIAN Debt Settlement (after voluntary loan repay, before Thievery).
 - **Order**: voluntary IOU repay → negotiation → forced liquidation (Defender picks unencumbered Asset; bank pays printed cost; pays Attacker MIN(IOU, available C); cascades).
 - **Elimination only if** unpaid IOU AND no unencumbered Assets AND no negotiated agreement.
 - **Tradable** during CIAN trading window. **Attacker elimination wipes their held IOUs**.
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Signing Bonus (RC-Z13-01 / 02 / 03 + RC-Z14-04)

One-time grant on **voluntary** Asset acquisition (Pre-Market, Brokerage, consensual trade). **Does NOT apply on forced/hostile transfers** (e.g., Hostile Takeover).

Tier	Signing Bonus
T1	none
T2	Gain 1 IP
T3	Gain 1 Power

Character Action — Free, Once per Round

Free Action. Cost paid in **IP or Power only** (never Coins) as printed. **Frequency: once per round** (1 use across both of your turns). (Z19 — *supersedes older "once per turn" wording.*) Character abilities are inherently Sacred.

Resource Flow Notation (PR-Z14-I)

Card text follows a consistent vocabulary:

Phrase	Meaning
gain X	Receive from supply (no transfer between players).
lose X	Lose to supply (no transfer).
pay X to [player]	Direct transfer from one player to another.
take X from [player] / steal X from [player]	Transfer from named player to playing player.

Defaults: "Attacker gains +Y" without source → supply. "Defender loses Y" without destination → supply.

Counter-Verbs (single-line)

Verb	Meaning
Cancel	Stops an Action entirely.
Counter	Negate via Reaction; subject to Counter Tier-Up.
Prevent	Block a specific effect (loss or damage).
Redirect	Send the effect to another player.
Replace	Discard 1 card of specified type → draw 1 new of same type.
Refuse	Defender ignores Action but suffers Refusal Penalty. Deprecated for Action cards (RC-Z14-05) — no current Action has a Refusal Penalty. Only counterplay against an Action is Counter via Reaction.

PR Bonus (Z12) — narrative valuation

On Action play / Reaction play / Character Ability / Asset ability trigger / Event draw — read the card's **Humor** text aloud. If any other player audibly reacts → **gain +1 Coin** from supply. Optics are an asset class. (Honor system; no automation.)

Source: documents/POWERPLAY OFFICIAL INSTRUCTIONS 03072026.md § II Glossary of Terms. REF-1 (2026-05-12).